perfect business sense. The biggies like IBM, Microsoft, Wipro, TCS and Tech Mahindra who set up shop much earlier have in the past three years been joined by well-known firms such as Calsoft, Zensar, LTI Mindtree, Grant Thornton and McKinsey. The newer lot have taken up close to a million square feet of space and have generated 20,000-plus jobs.

A Sector Transformed

Kolkata may still have a long way to go before it catches up with IT hubs such as Bengaluru and Hyderabad. Bengaluru's 5,500 companies employ 1.5 million people, while 900,000 IT professionals work in Hyderabad's 1,500 firms, compared to Kolkata's 260,000-strong IT workforce. But given the overstretched infrastructure in these two IT city giants, Kolkata offers an attractive alternative. "During the pandemic, IT companies came to recognise that Kolkata offered a valuable pool for their human resources," says R. Chandrasekhar, former president of NASSCOM. "But firms don't invest based on talent alone. Infrastructure and cost are critical. The infrastructure growth in Sector V and New Town is substantial." Alapan Bandyopadhyay, currently chief advisor to chief minister Mamata Banerjee and chairman of New Town Kolkata Development Authority (NKDA) and Nabadiganta Industrial Township Authority (NDITA), which oversee infrastructure and civic services in New Town and Sector V, agrees. "Since Kolkata had long been supplying talented professionals, IT companies found it worthwhile to refocus on the city to retain that talent," he says. "This made operations less expensive and more efficient."

The transformation in Kolkata's IT landscape is most visible in Sector V, which has seen 641 IT and ITeS companies set up operations between 2021 and May 2025, an average of 160-plus companies each year. The area received Rs 6,770 crore worth of investments from 2022 onwards. Spread across 432 acres, NDITA has around 250 buildings, with 80 per cent occupied by IT firms. Global Foundries, a leading American semiconductor developer, recently announced it is setting up shop in Sector V. In 2024–25, 152,231 employees were officially declared to be working in the area, mostly in the tech sector.

Meanwhile, some 5-6 km away, the 2,718-acre Action Area II in New Town has also seen an impressive surge in infrastructure. In the past three years, 30 IT and ITeS buildings and five data centres have been sanctioned, covering over 700,000 square metres. Industry leaders such as TCS, Infosys, Wipro, EY GDS, Deloitte USI, LTIMindtree, Zensar, Thoughtworks, STT Global, Reliance and Adani have either established or expanded operations here. Infosys's 320,000 sq. ft development centre in New Town, built with an investment of Rs 426 crore and inaugurated in December 2024, has further cemented confidence in the region. On July 1, Mamata announced the issuance of the occupancy certificate for ITC's 17-acre IT campus in New Town.

BSV, too, has come into its own in the past few months, with four data centres (facilities that house companies' IT infrastructure, including servers and storage) ready to kick off and office spaces being snapped up. On June 24, Mamata announced the sanction of the Phase I building plan for a 20-acre TCS office campus at BSV. The area has 41 companies now, including ST Telemedia and NTT Data, Airtel Nxtra and CtrlS—whose data centres are starting operations soon. The hub, in the NKDA area, has received investment proposals worth Rs 27,000 crore, mostly since 2021, promising to generate 75,000 direct and indirect jobs. As per government sources, besides TCS's 20 acres, the Adani group has taken up

MANY MILES TO GO

Good infrastructure, skilled workers, cheap real estate have helped Kolkata, but it lags behind Bengaluru and Hyderabad

	NO. OF IT FIRMS	EMPLOYEES	IT+ITeS EXPORTS (₹ crore)
KOLKATA	1,500	260,000	6,684
BENGALURU	5,500+	1.5 MN	4,53,600
HYDERABAD	1,500+	900,000	1,42,591

Note: All 2024-25 figures; Source: STPI, industry estimates



ANI

BENGAL REACHES OUT Tata Group chairperson N. Chandrasekaran meets West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee in Kolkata, Jul. 9